```
<script src="/assets/application.js"></script>
```

Assets are compiled and cached on the first request after the server is started. Sprockets sets a `must-revalidate` Cache-Control HTTP header to reduce request overhead on subsequent requests - on these the browser gets a 304 (Not Modified) response.

If any of the files in the manifest have changed between requests, the server responds with a new compiled file.

Debug mode can also be enabled in Rails helper methods:

```
<%= stylesheet_link_tag "application", debug: true %>
<%= javascript_include_tag "application", debug: true %>
```

The `:debug` option is redundant if debug mode is already on.

You can also enable compression in development mode as a sanity check, and disable it on-demand as required for debugging.

4 In Production

In the production environment Sprockets uses the fingerprinting scheme outlined above. By default Rails assumes assets have been precompiled and will be served as static assets by your web server.

During the precompilation phase an MD5 is generated from the contents of the compiled files, and inserted into the filenames as they are written to disc. These fingerprinted names are used by the Rails helpers in place of the manifest name.

For example this:

```
<%= javascript_include_tag "application" %>
<%= stylesheet_link_tag "application" %>
```

generates something like this:

```
<script src="/assets/application-
908e25f4bf641868d8683022a5b62f54.js"></script>
<link href="/assets/application-4dd5b109ee3439da54f5bdfd78a80473.css"
media="screen"
rel="stylesheet" />
```

Note: with the Asset Pipeline the :cache and :concat options aren't used anymore, delete these options from the `javascript_include_tag` and `stylesheet_link_tag`.

The fingerprinting behavior is controlled by the `config.assets.digest` initialization option (which defaults to `true` for production and `false` for everything else).

Under normal circumstances the default `config.assets.digest` option should not be changed. If there are no digests in the filenames, and far-future headers are set, remote clients will never know to refetch the files when their content changes.

4.1 Precompiling Assets

Rails comes bundled with a rake task to compile the asset manifests and other files in the pipeline.

Compiled assets are written to the location specified in `config.assets.prefix`. By default, this is the `/assets` directory.